Discussion of Possible Revisions to Board Policy DP (Local)

Recommendation:
That the Board of Trustees adopt updated Local Board Policy DP (Local) Personnel Positions.

Explanation:
The Administration recommended revisions to Board Policy DP (Local) Personnel Positions. The Administration recommends that the updated Local Board Policy DP (Local) be adopted as presented.

Policy Reference: DP Local

Recommended by:

Dr. Ted Landry
Interim Superintendent of Schools

Principal Qualifications

In addition to the minimal certification requirement, a principal shall have at least:

1. Working knowledge of curriculum and instruction;
2. The ability to evaluate instructional program and teaching effectiveness;
3. The ability to manage budgets and personnel and to coordinate campus functions;
4. The ability to explain policy, procedures, and data;
5. Strong communications, public relations, and interpersonal skills;
6. Prior experience in instructional leadership roles; and
7. Other qualifications deemed necessary by the Board and included in the job description.

School Counselors

In accordance with law, a school counselor shall spend 80 percent of the counselor's work time on duties that are components of a comprehensive school counseling program (CSCP). [See FFEA]

If the Board approves a determination by the administration that due to District or campus staffing needs or other reasons a school counselor is prevented from spending 80 percent of the counselor's work time on duties that are components of a CSCP, the Board shall direct the Superintendent to develop a revised job description for the school counselor that addresses the percentage of the school counselor's time that shall be spent on duties related to the components of a CSCP and the duties the school counselor is expected to perform in the remaining work time. The Superintendent shall report to the Board regarding adjustments to a school counselor's duties under this provision.

Chaplains

The District may approve a chaplain to provide student support, services, or programs on a volunteer basis. The Superintendent shall determine an application and screening process for chaplain candidates. All chaplains are subject to final approval by the Board.

Responsibilities

A chaplain shall:

1. Be available for any student who may seek such chaplain's help or care.
2. Be a visible, integral member of the assigned school or campus working to develop positive, supportive relationships based on compassion and mutual respect with any eligible students that so desire.
3. Be present and visible both in the various activities in which students participate during the school day and the areas of the school or campus at which students are found. A chaplain may refer eligible students to other resources and personnel the District provides that might assist the students in any given situation.
4. Not proselytize or disparage any religion, belief, lack of belief, or faith group. A chaplain's provision of care, help, or counsel consistent with his or her beliefs or convictions to students who seek such care, help, or counsel is not proselytization or disparagement.
5. Not have disciplinary authority over students or student groups.

Qualifications

For purposes of this policy, a chaplain shall be a person who obtains an ecclesiastical endorsement from his or her faith group certifying that such chaplain is:

1. A minister, rabbi, priest, imam, lay leader, or similar functionary of the faith group;
2. Qualified spiritually, morally, intellectually, and emotionally to serve as a chaplain for the District
3. Sensitive to religious pluralism and able to provide for the free exercise of religion by all students.

Opt-In Participation

Parental or guardian consent shall be required before a student may participate and deemed eligible in any support, service, or program provided by a chaplain. The District shall distribute consent forms at the beginning of each school year. Consent shall be valid only for the school year in which it is signed and may be revoked at any time by the parent or guardian. The District shall provide notice to the parent or guardian each time a student receives support, services, or participates in a program provided by a chaplain.

Prior to beginning service, a chaplain shall comply with all applicable requirements of Texas Education Code Chapter 22, Subchapter C.

The District shall not employ or accept as a volunteer any chaplain who has been convicted of, or received deferred adjudication community supervision for, an offense requiring registration as a sex offender under Chapter 62, Texas Code of Criminal Procedure.